

NICHOLAS KADUNCE

724-996-3792 · NicholasKadunce@gmail.com · nicholaskadunce.com · linkedin.com/in/nicholaskadunce

PLANT MANAGER · MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS

\$90M+ P&L · 100-PERSON ORGANIZATION · OPERATING SYSTEMS ADOPTED ACROSS A SIX-PLANT DIVISION

Plant Manager of a \$90M+ profit center for Jennmar, a privately held, private-equity-backed global manufacturer of ground-control products for underground mining and tunneling. Runs the plant on a daily management system the Reedsville team built, which now operates in all six plants of the division. Earlier operations, quality, and engineering roles at Eos Energy, Messer Americas, and Johnson Matthey. Lean Six Sigma Black Belt. B.S., Chemical Engineering.

Year one at Reedsville TRIR 4.2 → 1.6 · DART 3.3 → 0 · On-time delivery 97% → 99% · Cost per ton -15% · Inventory -27% · Operating income up

CORE COMPETENCIES

Operations Leadership P&L Management · Multi-Shift Plant Operations · S&OP and Capacity Planning · Capital Planning and Justification · Safety Leadership (OSHA) · ISO 9001 Quality Systems

Performance Management Daily Management Systems · KPI and OEE Reporting · Financial Forecasting and Cost Control · Planned Maintenance (CMMS) · Inventory and Working Capital Management

Continuous Improvement Lean Six Sigma (Black Belt) · One-Piece Flow and Line Balancing · SPC and Root Cause Analysis · Standard Work and 5S · Automation Business Cases

People Leadership Talent Development and Succession Planning · Front-Line Leader Coaching · Executive and Cross-Functional Communication · Change Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Jennmar · Reedsville, WV

January 2025 – Present

Plant Manager

Privately held, private-equity-backed global manufacturer of ground-control products for underground mining and tunneling; \$1B+ revenue; one of six bolt plants in the division.

\$90M+ P&L · ~100 PEOPLE (90 HOURLY, 10 SALARIED) · 7 DIRECT REPORTS · ~25,000 TONS/YR · ~80 SKUS · 11 PROCESSES · 27 PRODUCTION ASSETS · TWO SHIFTS · OWNS S&OP · REPORTS TO THE VP OF OPERATIONS · WEEKLY OPERATIONS REVIEW WITH THE DIVISION EXECUTIVE TEAM

Accountable for safety, quality, delivery, cost, working capital, and the capital plan. Took the seat with a mandate to build the plant's performance-management system, make results visible to the executive team, and bring in lean manufacturing.

- Cut the recordable injury rate (TRIR) from 4.2 to 1.6 and DART from 3.3 to zero, with no citations, by moving safety to leading indicators: layered audits, near-miss reporting with root-cause removal, machine guarding that eliminates hazards, and dust collection upgrades.
- Raised on-time delivery from 97% to 99% while holding a 5-day lead time, and brought customer complaints to zero. Established quality governance (automated tensile test logs, SPC by heat number, Pareto, tagged quarantine) that was adopted at every plant in the division.
- Grew output 3.2% with about 10% less hourly labor and 11% less overtime through standard work, workflow balancing, automation, and staffing leveled to demand with a headcount model built on the sales projection and OEE. Cost per ton fell 15% despite inflation; operating income improved.
- Reduced inventory 27% (more than \$3M) and days on hand from 80 to 65 by splitting roughly 80 SKUs into make-to-stock and make-to-order with min/max levels tied to demand; worked slow-moving stock from 2.2 to 0.3 days with the sales team and created the plant's first sales budget.
- Moved maintenance from reactive to planned with a CMMS rollout covering work orders, spares control, and maintenance analytics; corrective work orders fell from 159 to 50 per month.
- Won approval for the 2026 capital plan, \$900K across four projects, led by a \$750K integrated forging-and-assembly cell, the first of its kind in the company, projected to cut cycle time 45% with payback under three years; annual capital need fell from \$1.4M to \$0.9M.
- Delivered about \$250K per year in validated process savings, including \$35K in freight from relocating equipment to a sister plant. Rebalanced volume with that plant for four months so both met budget; overtime fell from 92 to 82 hours per employee biweekly and held after the volume returned.
- Built the Daily Operations Review (automated daily email and dashboard: safety, availability, inventory, sales to budget, quality, headcount, capex, lean) and a daily net-income Financial Forecaster; rolled both out in person to all six plants, where the executive team reviews them every Monday. IT now owns the platform and is extending it company-wide.
- Hired about 25 and promoted about 10, including the production supervisor developed into superintendent as planned succession; installed supervisor standard work and refined the per-piece incentive, automating its administration. Accountable for stormwater and waste permits, with no notices of violation.

Eos Energy Enterprises · Turtle Creek, PA

December 2023 – December 2024

Publicly traded US battery energy storage scale-up; 500 to 1,000 employees; revenue \$16M in 2024 and \$115M in 2025.

Operations Manager · June 2024 – December 2024

TWO PRODUCTION BUILDINGS · 240 TECHNICIANS AT PEAK · 11 SUPERVISORS AND 6 TEAM LEADS · REPORTED TO THE SR. DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS · OUTPUT PRESENTED DAILY TO THE EXECUTIVE TEAM

- Selected through a competitive process; started with one building (about 180 technicians) and took on the second when its manager left. Met every investor performance milestone while in the role, with no recordable injuries.
- Replaced a next-day count sheet with the company's first hour-by-hour production dashboards: OEE, gap analysis, and control charts.
- Cut module assembly time from 46.5 to 20.5 minutes by streamlining test and converting subassembly from batch to one-piece flow; subassembly rate up 41%, defects down 22%.
- Raised BESS output from 0.5 to 2.2 units per day, sustained, with Yamazumi balancing, takt alignment, and team workflows; rework down 66%.
- Recruited and trained a 40-person third shift in two months that led the plant on OEE within a month. Hired about 100, promoted 8, and sustained a 12-per-shift headcount reduction after subassembly automation.

Quality Engineer · December 2023 – June 2024

- Built the quality program from scratch: defect codes, a QMS, control plans, test protocols, and internal audits toward ISO 9001; directed the daily work of six quality technicians.
- Wrote the specifications and test regimen for the next-generation module and BESS launch ahead of production; cut testing cycle time about 60% and scrap defects 30%; automated quality records and Pareto dashboards.

Messer Americas · Northeast Region (PA, WV, ME)

October 2022 – December 2023

Privately held industrial gas producer (Messer Group, about 4.4 billion euros in revenue).

Regional Production Engineer

FOUR AIR SEPARATION PLANTS, ABOUT 80 EMPLOYEES · \$400K PROJECT AND EXPENSE BUDGET · NO DIRECT REPORTS · WEEKLY TRAVEL

- Initiated and led the Krypton/Xenon production project: output up 15% and \$1M+ in annual revenue validated by finance, with lower hydrocarbon concentration risk in the process. \$1.1M in total validated project value.
- Led 15+ reliability and capital projects across the region: 25 fewer downtime days per year, lead times down about 30 days, and about \$100K negotiated in vendor savings.
- Reorganized maintenance tools and spares at point of use with 5S and min/max levels by asset; the site teams owned the ideas and kept it running on their own.

Johnson Matthey · Smithfield, PA

September 2020 – October 2022

Global catalyst manufacturer headquartered in the UK; the plant produced heavy-duty diesel catalytic converters on a fully automated, high-mix line.

Production Team Shift Leader II · March 2022 – October 2022

- Ran the shift as acting supervisor: production timelines, safe practices, layered process audits, shift start and handover. Plant OEE rose from 76% to 81.2% in 2022 with zero lost-time and recordable injuries plant-wide.

Process Control Engineer · September 2020 – March 2022

- Owned setups and optimization of the automated line; cycle time down 8%, defects down 4%; a setup-parameter library removed 35 hours of annual changeover downtime; \$220K in savings validated by the CI manager.

CREDENTIALS, RECOGNITION, AND EDUCATION

Oct 2026	Cover feature, Metals & Mining Review · Leadership Perspectives, "Operational Performance Builder"; author of "Building Operations that Deliver Results"; Certificate of Editorial Recognition
Jul 2026	Applied Agentic AI for Organizational Transformation · MIT Professional Education
Apr 2026	Lean Six Sigma Black Belt Professional · Six Sigma Global Institute
Jun 2025	OSHA 30-Hour
Nov 2024	Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) · Scrum Alliance
Feb 2024	Certified Quality Management System Lead Auditor (ISO 9001) · Exemplar Global
Oct 2023	Certified Six Sigma Green Belt · Messer Americas EMBRACE Training Academy
Mar 2023	2022 EMBRACE Country Champion, Efficiency (United States) · Messer Americas
Education	B.S., Chemical Engineering · West Virginia University